



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Classical Christian Academy
School Website: <https://www.discovercca.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) or the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Classical Christian Academy Florida 33917 (CCA FL 33917) presents a robust classical Christian orientation with clear commitments to a Biblical worldview, a Trivium-inspired curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric), and a community framework that partners with families. Public-facing materials emphasize a hybrid model, a classical curriculum, and a faith-centered mission, including explicit statements about forming students as committed disciples of Jesus Christ. Evidence from the school's materials shows alignment with several core elements of classical education (biblical/theological grounding, formation of character, and a classical pedagogy anchored in the Trivium). However, explicit, sustained public emphasis on some hallmark classical practices (notably sustained Great Books/Great Conversation engagement, Socratic pedagogy across grades 9–12, and a liturgical rhythm as an integral daily practice) is less consistently visible in the available materials. Taken together, the school clearly leans CLASSICAL in several essential dimensions, but several category indicators suggest it falls into SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL overall rather than fully CLASSICAL.

Overall ranking: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Key insights - Strong religious/metaphysical grounding evidenced by Biblical worldview, covenantal language, and Christian formation as core aims (Element 1: Classical; evidence includes explicit statements about biblical worldview and Jesus-centered formation).

- Purpose/Goal reflects formation and virtue-oriented aims consistent with paideia, but public emphasis on the explicit transcendental triad (truth, goodness, beauty) and teleology is more implicit than explicit (Element 2: Somewhat Classical). See mission statements and descriptions of formation. - Curriculum shows strong classical markers (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Latin; staged progression) but less explicit public emphasis on Great Books/Great Conversation in the accessible materials (Element 3: Somewhat Classical). - Pedagogy includes elements typical of a classical program (grammar and memory-oriented practices in early grades; some exposure to Socratic-style inquiry in upper grades is not clearly evidenced in the accessible content) (Element 4: Somewhat Classical). - Faculty materials highlight long-tenured, credentialed teachers and a "living curriculum" approach, signaling a strong classical-influenced faculty culture (Element 5: Classical). - Parents & Community are actively engaged as co-educators, with explicit language about partnership and parent involvement (Element 6: Classical).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission and vision statements emphasize a Biblical worldview and formation around Christian faith. The school presents itself as forming "committed disciples of Jesus Christ" anchored in Scripture, and it describes a Biblical worldview as foundational to learning. - The public materials reference a covenantal/partnership model with families and a Christian formation ethos, signaling a theologically grounded educational frame.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators drawn from the Six Essential Elements lexicon include: theology, sacred tradition, biblical worldview, liturgy/worship, and the pursuit of truth with a sacred orientation. The site's explicit Biblical worldview, Christ-centered formation, and covenant language align

with these signals. See positive keyword lists (e.g., truth/goodness/beauty; theology; sacred tradition; liturgical practices) in the Six Elements lexicon. - Negative signals (values-neutral, secular humanism, relativism) are not evidenced in the public materials.

Why this rating - The school's public materials demonstrate a strong Christian/metaphysical framing and a clear emphasis on theology as a guide for education, which fits CLASSICAL in spirit for this category, though explicit liturgical routines are not widely documented in the accessible pages. The alignment is solid but not exhaustively explicit in every liturgical sense.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission emphasizes partnering with families to educate students to love God and serve Him, forming students with a biblical worldview and a classical approach to education. This centers formation and virtue over purely vocational outcomes. - The vision highlights formation of disciplined, truth-seeking students who live out a biblical worldview, indicating a telos oriented toward virtue and wisdom rather than only information transfer.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators include: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, truth/goodness/beauty, classical mission, and a life of faith integrated with study. These align with the lexicon's expectations for a classical mission (formation of character, pursuit of the true, good, and beautiful). See the lexicon's guidance on formation and telos. - The site's explicit emphasis on "formation" and "biblical worldview" supports CLASSICAL, whereas there is less explicit language around the broader, transcendental claims (truth/goodness/beauty) as public, explicit aims beyond formation.

Why this rating - The school prioritizes formation and virtue in a Christian framework, which aligns with classical aims for paideia, but the public messaging is more focused on faith and formation than on an explicit articulation of the transcendental triad as a universal aim. This places Element 2 in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials describe a classical curriculum emphasis: a staged approach (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and a focus on classical methods, including Latin and logic/rhetoric emphasis. The materials outline a "Classical Curriculum Overview" and reference to stages (Pre-Grammar, Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) in the accessible content. - The program highlights classical pedagogy and a curriculum designed to cultivate thinking, reasoning, and eloquence, with a Biblical worldview shaping coursework.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators include: grammar, logic, rhetoric (Trivium), Latin, great conversation/Great Books (where explicitly stated), and a commitment to classical memory and formation (as reflected in the curriculum sections). The lexicon's signs for Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Great Books/Great Conversation are appropriate positive signals when present. See the lexicon entries for Seven Liberal Arts and Great Books. - The materials do not consistently demonstrate explicit, sustained Great Books exposure in public-facing content (Great Books/Great Conversation are not repeatedly foregrounded in every page). This limits a full CLASSICAL alignment in this category.

Why this rating - The curriculum clearly reflects classical elements (grammar/logic/rhetoric, Latin, staged Trivium). However, the publicly visible emphasis on Great Books/Great Conversation and deep multi-disciplinary integration is not consistently explicit, placing Element 3 in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Lower-school pedagogy emphasis includes memory work and recitation elements implied by classical models (as described in the general classical approach and reflected in the materials' description of staged Classical education). The high-level description discusses a sequence of grammar/logic/rhetoric with memory-based methods. - Upper-school pedagogy references Socratic discussion and rhetoric training (per classical tradition); however, explicit public evidence of regular Socratic seminars or debates across grades

9–12 is not consistently demonstrated in the accessible content. The materials do mention seminars in the context of Classical Education generally, but the explicit routine of Socratic pedagogy is not foregrounded in the pages we can quote.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords from the Six Elements include: Socratic dialogue, recitation, chanting, seminar-based learning, and rhetoric training. The site does emphasize grammar/-logic/rhetoric and classical stages, and references to a classical approach, but explicit, repeated Socratic seminars are not consistently visible in the accessible content. See the lexicon's Pedagogy section for Socratic dialogue, recitation, and scholé; if not consistently evidenced, it reduces the strength in this category. - Negative indicators (e.g., project-based learning as the sole pedagogy, or experiential/project-based emphasis) are not dominant in the visible site content.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates classical pedagogy elements (grammar/logic/rhetoric, memory/recitation, and a classical progression), but the accessible content does not consistently show full Socratic seminars or a consistently contemplative “scholé” pace across all grades. Thus, Element 4 is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school highlights a long-tenured, degreed faculty and a culture where teachers are central to the living curriculum and student formation. The materials note “the average tenure of staff is more than 6 years” and emphasize the faculty as the core of the school and a key element of the living curriculum. This aligns with the classical model's ideal of virtuous, mission-aligned teachers. - The mission and tone describe faculty as partners in mentoring and curriculum delivery, reinforcing a virtuous, teacher-as-model ethos.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators from the Six Elements include: teachers as models of virtue, living curriculum, mentorship, and collegiality. The school's language about long-tenured, degreed teachers and a collaborative faculty supports these signals. See the lexicon's Faculty section for “teachers as models of virtue” and “living curriculum.”

Why this rating - The explicit portrayal of a stable, credentialed, and virtuous faculty who function as the living curriculum strongly supports CLASSICAL.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The materials emphasize partnering with families, parent involvement, and a model where parents are co-teachers and participants in the classical education process (e.g., mission statements and content describing partnership with families and worldviews). The school presents itself as a covenantal, family-centric community with a hybrid model that requires parent involvement in at-home days. - There is explicit emphasis on parent formation and engagement via resources, newsletters, and community activities; the site highlights family involvement and community-building aspects.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators from the Six Elements include: partnership with families; parent formation; living tradition in the family; home-school partnership; parental engagement; etc. The public materials show explicit parent-school partnership, a covenant model, and home-based learning components that align with these signals. See the lexicon's Parents and Community section for partnership and family formation signals.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates clear, explicit commitments to parental partnership and family involvement, meeting CLASSICAL signals in this category.

Aggregate assessment - Element 1: CLASSICAL - Element 2: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 5: CLASSICAL - Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall ranking: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

What would move the needle

- Increase explicit, public emphasis on Great Books and Great Conversation as central components of the curriculum (explicit listing of canonical texts and weekly or semester-long Great Books study across grades, with measurable discussion-based assessment).
- Expand explicit utilization of Socratic pedagogy across upper grades (documented practice: regular Socratic seminars, dialectic dialogues, and structured debates as a core pedagogy in 9–12).
- Increase explicit articulation of liturgical or liturgical-inspired communal practices (daily or weekly chapel, sacred music traditions, liturgical calendar integration) as formal, public components of the educational experience.
- Enhance public-facing descriptions of the Great Conversation framework, the Quadrivium elements (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) within the curriculum, and cross-disciplinary integration to demonstrate full alignment with the Seven Liberal Arts.
- Provide clearer public documentation of “living curriculum” through faculty exemplars and teacher-professional development in classical pedagogy, including explicit portrait of teacher as model of virtue in a public-facing format.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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